

AHK Academy - HOMEWORK 2: Leadership Storytelling

Building Speaking Skills (15 Minutes)

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Focus

Enhancing general life fluency and charisma in storytelling, with **Leadership English** integration for professional and casual settings. This exercise teaches **20 high-impact leadership vocabularies**, drills them through targeted exercises, and ends with video practice.

Powerful Lesson

“Great leaders don’t just manage projects—they inspire movements.”

Use these words to command respect, rally teams, and frame engineering challenges as leadership triumphs.

Step 1 (5 Minutes) - Learn the 20 Leadership Vocabularies

#	Vocabulary	Definition (Engineering Leadership Context)	Example in a Sentence
1	Visionary	Having bold, forward-thinking ideas	“We need a visionary redesign to future-proof this bridge.”
2	Empower	Give team members authority and trust	“I empowered the junior engineers to lead the soil tests.”
3	Accountability	Ownership of outcomes, good or bad	“Full accountability ensured zero

#	Vocabulary	Definition (Engineering Leadership Context)	Example in a Sentence
			delays in reporting.”
4	Resilience	Ability to recover from setbacks	“Our resilience turned flood damage into innovation.”
5	Decisive	Making firm, timely decisions	“A decisive pivot saved 15% on material costs.”
6	Influence	Ability to shape opinions without authority	“Her influence aligned stakeholders in one meeting.”
7	Integrity	Consistency between words and actions	“Integrity in data reporting built client trust.”
8	Mentorship	Guiding others to grow professionally	“Weekly mentorship sessions accelerated team skills.”
9	Agility	Adapting quickly to change	“Operational agility kept us on schedule during storms.”
10	Alignment	Unifying team goals and actions	“We achieved full alignment on the retrofit strategy.”
11	Catalyst	Person or action that sparks change	“The drone survey was the catalyst for redesign.”

#	Vocabulary	Definition (Engineering Leadership Context)	Example in a Sentence
12	Transparency	Open, honest communication	"Daily transparency updates reduced rumor and stress."
13	Ownership	Taking full responsibility for a task	"He took ownership of the cracking issue overnight."
14	Inspire	Motivate others to exceed expectations	"Her passion inspired a 48-hour repair sprint."
15	Strategic	Long-term, high-level planning	"A strategic material swap cut emissions by 30%."
16	Collaborate	Work jointly toward a shared goal	"We collaborated with contractors to beat the deadline."
17	Escalate	Raise an issue to higher authority	"We had to escalate the seismic risk to the board."
18	Delegate	Assign tasks to develop others	"I delegated the sensor calibration to build confidence."
19	Mitigate	Reduce risk or negative impact	"Early testing helped mitigate structural failure."
20	Legacy	Lasting impact of your leadership	"This highway will be our legacy of safety and speed."

Step 2 (5 Minutes) - Solve and Apply: 3 Quick Vocabulary Drills

Drill 1: Fill-in-the-Leadership-Arc (1 min)

Rewrite this weak story using **5 vocab words** from the list:

Weak: "We had a problem with the foundation. I told people what to do. It got fixed."

Strong (you write):

- **Hook:** "One tremor threatened to erase years of work..."

- **Build-up:** "I _____ the team to _____ the risk..."

- **Climax:** "With _____, we made a _____ call..."

- **Resolution:** "This became our _____ of _____."

Drill 2: 60-Second Leadership Swap (2 min)

Pick **ONE** engineering challenge you faced.

Replace **3 ordinary verbs** with leadership vocab:

- Instead of "told" → **empower** / **delegate**

- Instead of "fixed" → **mitigate** / **catalyze**

- Instead of "helped" → **inspire** / **align**

Example:

> Before: "I told the team to check the bolts."

> After: "I **delegated** bolt inspections to **empower** rising talent."

Drill 3: One-Word Impact Close (2 min)

For each word below, write **1 leadership sentence** tied to an engineering win:

1. **Resilience**

2. **Transparency**

3. **Legacy**

4. **Catalyst**

5. **Influence**

Example:

> **Resilience:** "Our resilience turned a collapsed scaffold into a safer design standard."

Step 3 (5 Minutes) - Record and Send Video: “My Leadership Moment”

Task: Record a **1-2 minute video** telling **one true leadership story** from your career (e.g., leading a crisis fix, mentoring a failing team, or pushing a bold idea).

Rules:

- Use the **Story Arc** (Hook → Build-up → Climax → Resolution)
- Include **at least 8 of the 20 vocab words** (highlight them in your mind as you speak)
- Deliver with **charisma**: varied tone, pauses, eye contact, positive energy
- Speak as if presenting to a **promotion panel** or **international conference**

Self-Check Before Sending:

- Did I use **8+ vocab words** naturally?
- Did I **inspire** the listener?
- Did I end with a **powerful legacy** or lesson?

Send the video to me for feedback.

“Leadership is not about being in charge. It’s about taking care of those in your charge.”

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